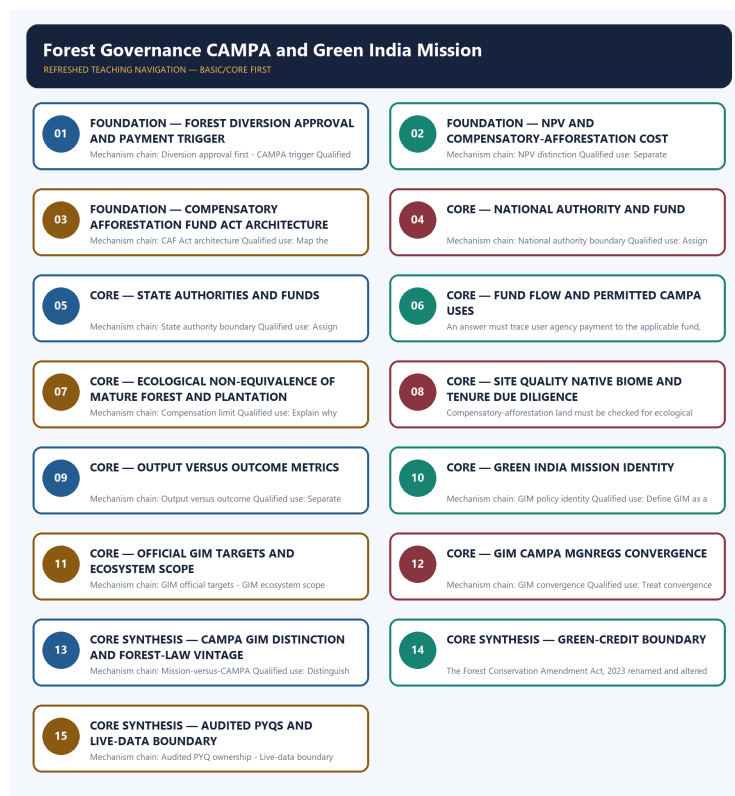


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision, ecological rate, species count or current status was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Audited ledgers route four objective demands: CAMPA in 2019, the New York Declaration on Forests and Tree City in 2021, and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community forest carbon. No direct Mains demand or objective answer key is invented; the concepts are carried into practice.
- **Live-link boundary:** The official MoEFCC GIM page was substantively retrieved for mission identity, ecosystem scope, convergence and published targets. Those targets are not reported as achievements. CAMPA paths failed with HTTP 404 or DNS error and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, area, survival or outcome figure was used.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports. Stubs, access failures, unrelated pages and thin landing pages are recorded and are not converted into ecological or current-status claims.

- <https://moef.gov.in/green-india-mission-gim> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page was substantively retrievable. It identifies GIM as one of the original eight NAPCC missions, states its ecosystem-service approach and publishes mission targets; targets were not reported as achieved outputs or outcomes.
- <https://moef.gov.in/forest-conservation> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page returned substantive Hindi text confirming that prior Central approval regulates forest land used for non-forest purposes. It did not provide a CAMPA fund or expenditure figure.
- <https://moef.gov.in/campa> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC path returned HTTP 404, so no fund allocation, release, expenditure or afforestation-area claim was imported.
- <https://campa.gov.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the host could not be resolved, so no National or State CAMPA dashboard value was used.
- <https://fsi.nic.in/forest-report-2023> - attempted 2026-09-03; the fetch returned only the Forest Survey of India contact address, so no forest-cover or restoration-outcome figure was imported.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Environment and Ecology Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Ecology boundary	System boundary, scale, trophic level, stock/flow, pool/flux, gross/net, unit and time interval are explicit.
Species boundary	Taxon, range, habitat, population trend, IUCN assessment, Indian legal schedule, CITES/CMS listing and endemism remain distinct.
Law/status boundary	Act, amendment, rule, notification, draft, judgment, policy, target, implementation and observed outcome remain distinct and dated.
Institution boundary	Legal form, parent authority, mandate, jurisdiction, standard, consent, enforcement, science and adjudication are not conflated.
Treaty boundary	Membership, annex/appendix, amendment acceptance, target, COP decision, national instrument and outcome remain distinct.
Climate boundary	Emission flow, concentration stock, cumulative budget, forcing, scenario, baseline, unit, mitigation, adaptation, loss-and-damage, avoidance and removal are exact.
Pollution boundary	Source, emission/load, ambient concentration, exposure, parameter, averaging period, unit, standard and jurisdiction are explicit.
Causal method	Chronology, designation, expenditure, capacity, registration and correlation are not promoted into ecological or policy outcomes without mechanism and evidence.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved : false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\basic\12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\learning-sessions\v2\subject-wide-syllabus\environment-and-ecology-12_Learning-Session.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\advanced\12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md

Official syllabus mapping:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

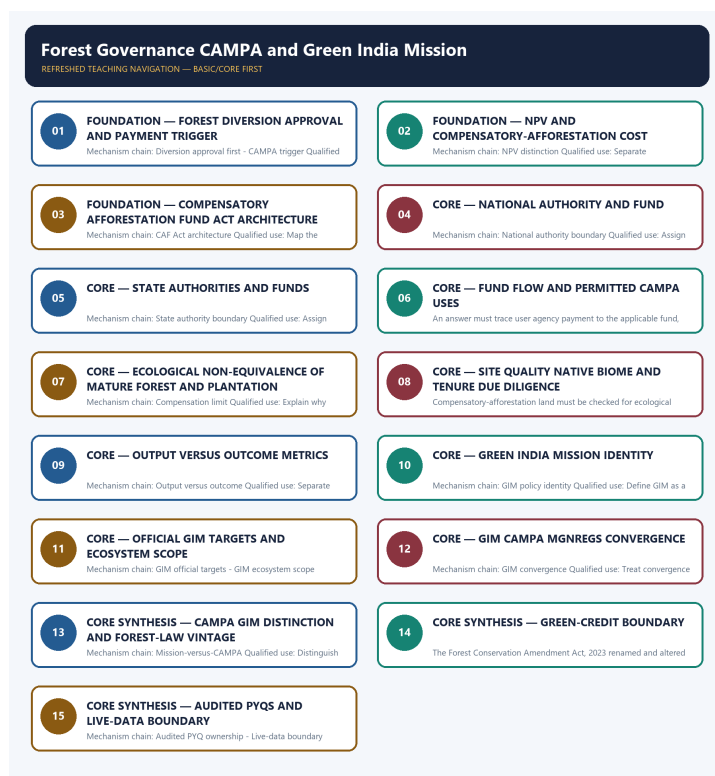
- Ecological mechanisms retain direction, pool, flux, limiting factor, spatial scale and time scale.
- Current species/news claims retain taxon, source, event/publication date, assessment/listing date and access date.
- IUCN category never substitutes for Wildlife Protection Act schedule, CITES appendix, CMS appendix or endemism.
- Protected-area categories, treaty designations and institution mandates retain exact legal character.
- Acts, amendments, rules, draft instruments, notifications and judgments retain operative status and date.
- Climate figures retain unit, baseline, period, scenario and stock-flow character; global evidence is not silently downscaled to India.
- Mitigation, adaptation and loss-and-damage remain separate; allowance, offset, avoidance, removal, capture and storage remain separate.
- PYQ wording is preserved only where verified; reconstructed or routed demands remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-03:** volatile targets, standards, schedules, species status, treaty outcomes and programme claims retain source/date/status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://moef.gov.in/green-india-mission-gim> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page was substantively retrievable. It identifies GIM as one of the original eight NAPCC missions, states its ecosystem-service approach and publishes mission targets; targets were not reported as achieved outputs or outcomes.
- <https://moef.gov.in/forest-conservation> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page returned substantive Hindi text confirming that prior Central approval regulates forest land used for non-forest purposes. It did not provide a CAMPA fund or expenditure figure.
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- <https://campa.gov.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the host could not be resolved, so no National or State CAMPA dashboard value was used.
- <https://fsi.nic.in/forest-report-2023> - attempted 2026-09-03; the fetch returned only the Forest Survey of India contact address, so no forest-cover or restoration-outcome figure was imported.

Topic 26 dedicated Disaster Management cross-owners (scope boundary):

- Not applicable to this topic.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - FOREST DIVERSION APPROVAL AND PAYMENT TRIGGER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Diversion approval first - CAMPA trigger Qualified use: Begin with the legal decision, then trace conditions to user-agency payment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Do not treat CAMPA payment as the legal approval for diversion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Forest diversion approval**
- **payment trigger**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Prior Central**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Forest diversion approval, connect payment trigger with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FOREST DIVERSION APPROVAL AND PAYMENT TRIGGER

01. Diversion approval first

|
v

02. CAMPA trigger

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat CAMPA payment as the legal approval for diversion.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.
- When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat CAMPA payment as the legal approval for diversion.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the legal decision, then trace conditions to user-agency payment.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Diversion approval first -> CAMPA trigger
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the legal decision, then trace conditions to user-agency payment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - FOREST DIVERSION APPROVAL AND PAYMENT TRIGGER

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Forest diversion approval and payment trigger

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Forest diversion approval · payment trigger · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Prior Central

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Diversion approval first - CAMPA trigger Qualified use: Begin with the legal decision, then trace conditions to user-agency payment.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Do not treat CAMPA payment as the legal approval for diversion.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - NPV AND COMPENSATORY-AFFORESTATION COST

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: NPV distinction Qualified use: Separate ecosystem-service valuation from activity cost.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- NPV
- compensatory-afforestation cost
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Net Present Value

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define NPV, connect compensatory-afforestation cost with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NPV AND COMPENSATORY-AFFORESTATION COST

01. NPV distinction

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge NPV and compensatory-afforestation cost.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge NPV and compensatory-afforestation cost.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate ecosystem-service valuation from activity cost.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** NPV distinction
- **Qualified use:** Separate ecosystem-service valuation from activity cost.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - NPV AND COMPENSATORY-AFFORESTATION COST

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - NPV and compensatory-afforestation cost

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • NPV • compensatory-afforestation cost • Mechanism chain • Qualified use •
Net Present Value

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: NPV distinction Qualified use: Separate ecosystem-service valuation from activity cost.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge NPV and compensatory-afforestation cost.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - COMPENSATORY AFFORESTATION FUND ACT ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: CAF Act architecture Qualified use: Map the statute, funds and authorities before discussing implementation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act architecture**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act**
- **National**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act architecture, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

COMPENSATORY AFFORESTATION FUND ACT ARCHITECTURE

01. CAF Act architecture

BOUNDARY -> Do not assign State implementation to the National Authority.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assign State implementation to the National Authority.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Map the statute, funds and authorities before discussing implementation.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** CAF Act architecture
- **Qualified use:** Map the statute, funds and authorities before discussing implementation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - COMPENSATORY AFFORESTATION FUND ACT ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act architecture

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act architecture · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act · National

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: CAF Act architecture Qualified use: Map the statute, funds and authorities before discussing implementation.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assign State implementation to the National Authority.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

SESSION 4 - CORE - NATIONAL AUTHORITY AND FUND

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: National authority boundary Qualified use: Assign central planning and monitoring to the National layer.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- National Authority
- Fund
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- The National Authority
- National Fund

How to use them: Frame the answer through National Authority; define Fund, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The National Authority for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NATIONAL AUTHORITY AND FUND

01. National authority boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not assign national coordination to a State Authority.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assign national coordination to a State Authority.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Assign central planning and monitoring to the National layer.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** National authority boundary
- **Qualified use:** Assign central planning and monitoring to the National layer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - NATIONAL AUTHORITY AND FUND

START / CONCEPT: CORE - National Authority and Fund

|

v

EXACT TERMS: National Authority · Fund · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · The National Authority · National Fund

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: National authority boundary Qualified use: Assign central planning and monitoring to the National layer.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assign national coordination to a State Authority.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

SESSION 5 - CORE - STATE AUTHORITIES AND FUNDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: State authority boundary Qualified use: Assign state plans and execution to the State layer.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Funds**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Qualified**
- **Assign**
- **CORE - State Authorities and Funds**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Funds; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Qualified to explain the mechanism, and use Assign for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STATE AUTHORITIES AND FUNDS

01. State authority boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat an approved annual plan as completed work.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat an approved annual plan as completed work.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Assign state plans and execution to the State layer.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** State authority boundary
- **Qualified use:** Assign state plans and execution to the State layer.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - STATE AUTHORITIES AND FUNDS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - State Authorities and Funds

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Funds · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Qualified · Assign · CORE - State Authorities and Funds

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: State authority boundary Qualified use: Assign state plans and execution to the State layer.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not treat an approved annual plan as completed work.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: state Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

SESSION 6 - CORE - FUND FLOW AND PERMITTED CAMPA USES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

Technical definition: An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fund flow
- permitted CAMPA uses
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- CAMPA
- Act

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fund flow; define permitted CAMPA uses, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use CAMPA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FUND FLOW AND PERMITTED CAMPA USES

01. Fund-flow discipline

|

v

02. Permitted-use boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not report accrued funds as expenditure.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.
- CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not report accrued funds as expenditure.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace the fund stages and name only uses allowed by the Act, Rules and plan.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Fund-flow discipline -> Permitted-use boundary
- **Qualified use:** Trace the fund stages and name only uses allowed by the Act, Rules and plan.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - FUND FLOW AND PERMITTED CAMPA USES

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Fund flow and permitted CAMPA uses

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Fund flow · permitted CAMPA uses · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · CAMPA · Act

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Fund-flow discipline - Permitted-use boundary Qualified use:

Trace the fund stages and name only uses allowed by the Act, Rules and plan.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not report accrued funds as expenditure.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: trace the fund stages and name only uses allowed by the Act, Rules and...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

SESSION 7 - CORE - ECOLOGICAL NON-EQUIVALENCE OF MATURE FOREST AND PLANTATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Compensation limit Qualified use: Explain why restoration finance cannot establish like-for-like replacement.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Ecological non-equivalence of mature forest
- plantation
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Compensation
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Ecological non-equivalence of mature forest; define plantation, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Compensation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ECOLOGICAL NON-EQUIVALENCE OF MATURE FOREST AND PLANTATION

01. Compensation limit

BOUNDARY -> Do not report expenditure as plantation survival or ecosystem restoration.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not report expenditure as plantation survival or ecosystem restoration.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Explain why restoration finance cannot establish like-for-like replacement.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Compensation limit

- **Qualified use:** Explain why restoration finance cannot establish like-for-like replacement.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - ECOLOGICAL NON-EQUIVALENCE OF MATURE FOREST AND PLANTATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Ecological non-equivalence of mature forest and plantation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Ecological non-equivalence of mature forest · plantation · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Compensation · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Compensation limit Qualified use: Explain why restoration finance cannot establish like-for-like replacement.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not report expenditure as plantation survival or ecosystem restoration.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Explain why restoration finance cannot establish like-for-like replacement.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

SESSION 8 - CORE - SITE QUALITY NATIVE BIOME AND TENURE DUE DILIGENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Site and tenure due diligence Qualified use: Test ecology, land tenure and pending rights before site selection.

Technical definition: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Site and tenure due diligence Qualified use: Test ecology, land tenure and pending rights before site selection.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Site quality native biome**
- **tenure due diligence**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Compensatory-afforestation**
- **Site**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Site quality native biome; define tenure due diligence, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Compensatory-afforestation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SITE QUALITY NATIVE BIOME AND TENURE DUE DILIGENCE

01. Site and tenure due diligence

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat compensatory plantation as like-for-like mature forest.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat compensatory plantation as like-for-like mature forest.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Test ecology, land tenure and pending rights before site selection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Site and tenure due diligence
- **Qualified use:** Test ecology, land tenure and pending rights before site selection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SITE QUALITY NATIVE BIOME AND TENURE DUE DILIGENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Site quality native biome and tenure due diligence

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Site quality native biome · tenure due diligence · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
Compensatory-afforestation · Site

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability,
native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as
degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not treat compensatory plantation as like-for-like mature forest.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: site and tenure due diligence
Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Site and tenure due diligence Qualified use: Test
ecology, land tenure and pending rights before site selection.

SESSION 9 - CORE - OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME METRICS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Output versus outcome Qualified use: Separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Output versus outcome Qualified use: Separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Output versus outcome metrics**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Money**
- **Do not assume degraded land**
- **Output**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Output versus outcome metrics; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Money to explain the mechanism, and use Do not assume degraded land for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME METRICS

01. Output versus outcome

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume degraded land is rights-free.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume degraded land is rights-free.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Output versus outcome
- **Qualified use:** Separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME METRICS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Output versus outcome metrics

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Output versus outcome metrics · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Money · Do not assume degraded land · Output

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assume degraded land is rights-free.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Output versus outcome Qualified use: Separate accrual, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome.

SESSION 10 - CORE - GREEN INDIA MISSION IDENTITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: GIM policy identity Qualified use: Define GIM as a NAPCC mission, not a compensatory fund.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Green India Mission identity
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- The Green India Mission
- National Action Plan
- Climate Change

How to use them: Frame the answer through Green India Mission identity; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with The Green India Mission to explain the mechanism, and use National Action Plan for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

GREEN INDIA MISSION IDENTITY

01. GIM policy identity

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge CAMPA and Green India Mission.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge CAMPA and Green India Mission.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Define GIM as a NAPCC mission, not a compensatory fund.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** GIM policy identity
- **Qualified use:** Define GIM as a NAPCC mission, not a compensatory fund.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - GREEN INDIA MISSION IDENTITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Green India Mission identity

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Green India Mission identity • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • The Green India Mission • National Action Plan • Climate Change

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: GIM policy identity Qualified use: Define GIM as a NAPCC mission, not a compensatory fund.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge CAMPA and Green India Mission.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

SESSION 11 - CORE - OFFICIAL GIM TARGETS AND ECOSYSTEM SCOPE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: GIM official targets - GIM ecosystem scope Qualified use: Quote official targets as targets and connect them to ecosystem services.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: GIM official targets - GIM ecosystem scope Qualified use: Quote official targets as targets and connect them to ecosystem services.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Official GIM targets
- ecosystem scope
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- MoEFCC
- GIM

How to use them: Frame the answer through Official GIM targets; define ecosystem scope, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use MoEFCC for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

OFFICIAL GIM TARGETS AND ECOSYSTEM SCOPE

01. GIM official targets

|
v

02. GIM ecosystem scope

BOUNDARY -> Do not report GIM targets as achieved outputs or outcomes.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.
- The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not report GIM targets as achieved outputs or outcomes.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Quote official targets as targets and connect them to ecosystem services.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** GIM official targets -> GIM ecosystem scope
- **Qualified use:** Quote official targets as targets and connect them to ecosystem services.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - OFFICIAL GIM TARGETS AND ECOSYSTEM SCOPE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Official GIM targets and ecosystem scope

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Official GIM targets · ecosystem scope · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · MoEFCC · GIM

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not report GIM targets as achieved outputs or outcomes.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: GIM official targets - GIM ecosystem scope Qualified use: Quote official targets as targets and connect them to ecosystem services.

SESSION 12 - CORE - GIM CAMPA MGNREGS CONVERGENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: GIM convergence Qualified use: Treat convergence as coordinated planning rather than automatic fund merger.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- GIM CAMPA MGNREGS convergence
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- MoEFCC
- CAMPA
- MGNREGS

How to use them: Frame the answer through GIM CAMPA MGNREGS convergence; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with MoEFCC to explain the mechanism, and use CAMPA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

GIM CAMPA MGNREGS CONVERGENCE

01. GIM convergence

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer fund convergence from policy convergence.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer fund convergence from policy convergence.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Treat convergence as coordinated planning rather than automatic fund merger.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** GIM convergence
- **Qualified use:** Treat convergence as coordinated planning rather than automatic fund merger.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - GIM CAMPA MGNREGS CONVERGENCE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - GIM CAMPA MGNREGS convergence

|

v

EXACT TERMS: GIM CAMPA MGNREGS convergence · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · MoEFCC · CAMPA · MGNREGS

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: GIM convergence Qualified use: Treat convergence as coordinated planning rather than automatic fund merger.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not infer fund convergence from policy convergence.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Treat convergence as coordinated planning rather than automatic fund merger.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - CAMPA GIM DISTINCTION AND FOREST-LAW VINTAGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Mission-versus-CAMPA Qualified use: Distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Mission-versus-CAMPA Qualified use: Distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **CAMPA GIM distinction**
- **forest-law vintage**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **CAMPA**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define CAMPA GIM distinction, connect forest-law vintage with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CAMPA GIM DISTINCTION AND FOREST-LAW VINTAGE

01. Mission-versus-CAMPA

BOUNDARY -> Do not state the 2023 amendment without the 2024 interim judicial direction.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not state the 2023 amendment without the 2024 interim judicial direction.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Mission-versus-CAMPA
- **Qualified use:** Distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - CAMPA GIM DISTINCTION AND FOREST-LAW VINTAGE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - CAMPA GIM distinction and forest-law vintage

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • CAMPA GIM distinction • forest-law vintage • Mechanism chain •
Qualified use • CAMPA

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not state the 2023 amendment without the 2024 interim judicial direction.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Mission-versus-CAMPA Qualified use: Distinguish CAMPA and GIM while stating the statute-court sequence.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - GREEN-CREDIT BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Forest-law vintage - Green-credit boundary Qualified use: Keep green credit separate from carbon accounting and restoration proof.

Technical definition: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Forest-law vintage - Green-credit boundary Qualified use: Keep green credit separate from carbon accounting and restoration proof.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Green-credit boundary
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- The Forest Conservation Amendment Act
- Supreme Court's February

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Green-credit boundary, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The Forest Conservation Amendment Act for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

GREEN-CREDIT BOUNDARY

01. Forest-law vintage

|

v

02. Green-credit boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate green credit with carbon credit.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.
- A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate green credit with carbon credit.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Keep green credit separate from carbon accounting and restoration proof.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Forest-law vintage -> Green-credit boundary
- **Qualified use:** Keep green credit separate from carbon accounting and restoration proof.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - GREEN-CREDIT BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Green-credit boundary

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Green-credit boundary • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • The Forest Conservation Amendment Act • Supreme Court's February

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not equate green credit with carbon credit.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Forest-law vintage - Green-credit boundary Qualified use: Keep green credit separate from carbon accounting and restoration proof.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - AUDITED PYQS AND LIVE-DATA BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Audited PYQ ownership - Live-data boundary Qualified use: Close with answer-free PYQs and failed current fund-data attempts.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Audited PYQ ownership - Live-data boundary Qualified use: Close with answer-free PYQs and failed current fund-data attempts.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Audited PYQs
- live-data boundary
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Audited PYQs, connect live-data boundary with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AUDITED PYQS AND LIVE-DATA BOUNDARY

01. Audited PYQ ownership

|
v

02. Live-data boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer PYQ keys or current fund figures from stubs.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.
- Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer PYQ keys or current fund figures from stubs.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Close with answer-free PYQs and failed current fund-data attempts.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Audited PYQ ownership -> Live-data boundary
- **Qualified use:** Close with answer-free PYQs and failed current fund-data attempts.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims. **Core area:** Compensatory afforestation and national forest-restoration policy. **Grounded in:** Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 (India Code); National Mission for a Green India (under NAPCC); MoEFCC/FSI reporting; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. *Companion:* advanced/12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md.

1. Visual foundation

```
graph TD; A[FOREST LAND DIVERTED FOR NON-FOREST (DEVELOPMENT) USE] --> B[v]; B --> C[USER AGENCY PAYS: Net Present Value (NPV) of forest land + cost of Compensatory Afforestation]; C --> D[v]; D --> E[FUNDS FLOW TO: CAMPA (Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority)]; E --> F[v]; F --> G[National CAF  
(kept centrally,  
smaller retained share)]; F --> H[State CAFs  
(released to states for  
compensatory afforestation,  
forest regeneration, wildlife  
management, infrastructure)]
```

SEPARATELY: GREEN INDIA MISSION (GIM) - one of NAPCC's original 8 missions (NAPCC is now described by Government as 9 missions, with health added) - targets forest/tree-cover QUALITY improvement and ecosystem-service enhancement, not only quantity-replacement for diverted forest land.

Core proposition: CAMPA is a compensatory financial mechanism specifically tied to diversion of forest land for non-forest use, funded by user agencies; the Green India Mission is a broader national climate-and-ecosystem policy goal aiming to improve forest quality and cover more generally - the two are related but distinct forest-governance instruments with different triggers and objectives.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Compensatory afforestation	Afforestation undertaken to compensate for forest land diverted to non-forest use, typically on equivalent non-forest land (or degraded forest land where non-forest land is unavailable).
FACT: Net Present Value (NPV)	A calculated monetary value of the ecosystem services lost when forest land is diverted, paid by the user agency into the CAF.
FACT: CAMPA	Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority - manages funds collected for compensatory afforestation and related forest/wildlife activities.
FACT: Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016	Law establishing the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds (CAF) and their governance/utilisation framework.
FACT: Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980	The renamed Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980 - the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act, 2023 changed its title and restructured its scope. This is the statute whose prior approval is required before forest land is diverted to non-forest use, and it is therefore the <i>trigger</i> for CAMPA payments.
FACT: Green India Mission (GIM)	One of the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC) missions, focused on protecting, restoring and enhancing India's forest cover and ecosystem services. ANALYSIS: NAPCC was launched with eight missions; the Economic Survey 2025-26 (Ch. 10) now describes NAPCC as operating through nine missions, the ninth being on health (the National Programme on Climate Change and Human Health). State both if a question asks for the count.
FACT: National Afforestation Programme (NAP)	A distinct, older centrally sponsored afforestation scheme for degraded forest land, involving Joint Forest Management Committees.
FACT: Green Credit Programme	A market-style instrument notified under the Environment (Protection) Act (Green Credit Rules, 2023) under which entities earn tradable green credits for voluntary environmental actions, most prominently tree plantation on degraded forest land. Economic Survey 2025-26 refers to the combined " Afforestation and Green Credit Programme " as the vehicle for incentivising public and private participation in compensatory afforestation and degraded-forest restoration. ANALYSIS: Distinguish it sharply from a carbon credit (Topic 21): a green credit is not denominated in tCO ₂ e.

3. Topic mechanism

- When forest land is legally diverted for a non-forest purpose (e.g., mining, roads, industry) under the **Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980** (the renamed Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980), the user agency must pay compensatory- afforestation costs and the calculated Net Present Value of the diverted forest land.
- The **Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act, 2023** made three structural changes worth knowing precisely: (i) it **renamed** the 1980 Act; (ii) it specified the **categories of land to which the Act applies** - land declared/notified as forest under the Indian Forest Act, 1927 or any other law, and land recorded as forest in government records on or after 25 October 1980; and (iii) it **exempted certain categories** from prior approval, notably land within 100 km of international borders/LoC/LAC proposed for strategic linear projects of national importance and security, small tracts for security infrastructure and defence projects, and land alongside rail lines/public roads for

access facilities, subject to conditions.

3. ANALYSIS: **The judicial counterweight:** the Supreme Court's **February 2024** interim direction in the *Ashok Kumar Sharma v. Union of India* proceedings required that, pending the compilation of State expert-committee forest records, the **broad "dictionary meaning" of forest laid down in T.N. Godavarman Thirumulpad (1996)** continue to govern - preserving protection for forest-like land that is not formally recorded as forest. Read the amendment and this order **together**: the statute narrowed the recorded-forest test, the Court kept the ecological test alive in the interim.

4. These payments accumulate in the Compensatory Afforestation Fund (CAF), structured as a National CAF (retaining a smaller share centrally) and State CAFs (receiving the larger share for actual afforestation and forest-management activities in the respective state).

5. CAMPA, established under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016, is the statutory authority managing planning, fund release and monitoring of how these funds are utilised by states for compensatory afforestation, forest regeneration, wildlife management, and forest infrastructure.

6. The Green India Mission, in contrast, is a broader climate-policy mission (part of NAPCC) aiming to increase forest/tree cover quality and area on a defined target timeline, using multiple funding streams (not only CAMPA funds) and emphasising ecosystem-service value (carbon sequestration, biodiversity, water regulation) alongside simple area coverage.

7. Both mechanisms interact with, but are legally distinct from, the National Afforestation Programme, the Green Credit Programme and various state-specific afforestation schemes, creating a layered (and sometimes overlapping) forest-restoration funding landscape in India.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **CAMPA (national and state-level bodies):** manages Compensatory Afforestation Fund planning, disbursal and utilisation monitoring.

- FACT: **MoEFCC:** administers the Forest (Conservation) Act diversion-approval process that triggers CAMPA payments, and oversees Green India Mission implementation.

- FACT: **State Forest Departments:** primary on-ground implementing agencies for both CAMPA-funded afforestation and Green India Mission activities.

- FACT: **Forest Survey of India (FSI):** monitors forest-cover change that indirectly reflects the combined outcome of these programmes.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: Large infrastructure and mining projects requiring forest-land diversion (e.g., in central Indian mineral-rich forest states) are the primary source of CAMPA fund inflows, linking industrial/infrastructure growth directly to afforestation-funding availability.

- ANALYSIS: Green India Mission implementation has focused on landscape-level restoration (including agroforestry, wetland and grassland ecosystem components), reflecting its broader ecosystem-service mandate beyond simple tree planting.

- ANALYSIS: Community involvement (e.g., through Joint Forest Management Committees historically associated with the National Afforestation Programme, and increasingly Community Forest Resource rights-holders under the FRA) is an important implementation channel for both CAMPA-funded and Green India Mission afforestation activities.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: CAMPA is triggered specifically by diversion of forest land for non-forest use and is funded by user-agency payments (Net Present Value plus compensatory-afforestation cost).

- FACT: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 established the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and CAMPA's statutory governance structure.

- FACT: The Green India Mission is one of the **eight original** missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC); the Government now describes NAPCC as operating through nine missions, with health added.
- FACT: The ****Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980** was renamed the Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980** by the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act, 2023, which also defined the land categories covered and created border-area/strategic-project and rail/road-side exemptions from prior central approval.
- FACT: The Supreme Court in **February 2024** directed that the broad *Godavarman* (1996) "dictionary meaning" of forest continue to apply pending State expert-committee records - so the operative definition of "forest" is currently the product of statute **and** judicial order together.
- FACT: **Green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) are not carbon credits** - they reward specified voluntary environmental actions and are not denominated in tCO₂e.
- FACT: Compensatory afforestation is required to occur on non-forest land equivalent in extent to the diverted area, or on degraded forest land twice the extent if non-forest land is unavailable.
- FACT: The Green India Mission's mandate covers forest-cover quality, ecosystem-service enhancement and biodiversity - broader than a simple area-replacement objective.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: CAMPA and the Green India Mission are the same programme. -> CAMPA is a compensatory, diversion-triggered financial mechanism; GIM is a broader NAPCC climate-policy mission with its own objectives and funding streams.
- WRONG: Compensatory afforestation always occurs on forest land. -> It is required on equivalent non-forest land where available, or on a larger area of degraded forest land as a fallback.
- WRONG: CAMPA funds are entirely retained by the central government. -> A larger share flows to State CAFs for state-level utilisation; a smaller share is retained nationally.
- WRONG: The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text. -> It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.
- WRONG: The National Afforestation Programme and CAMPA are identical schemes. -> They are distinct funding/implementation mechanisms, though both fund afforestation activity.
- WRONG: The Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980 has been repealed. -> It was **renamed** the Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980 and amended in 2023; it remains in force.
- WRONG: A green credit is a carbon credit by another name. -> Green credits (2023 Rules) reward specified voluntary environmental actions such as plantation; carbon credit certificates under the CCTS (Topic 21) are denominated in tonnes of CO₂-equivalent.
- WRONG: After the 2023 amendment, only land recorded as forest in government records is protected. -> The Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction kept the broader *Godavarman* ecological definition operative pending State records.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: Cumulative CAMPA fund accrual (principal and interest from diverted-forest-land payments) has been reported at a large and growing figure by MoEFCC/CAG-linked reporting in recent years; verify the latest cumulative CAF corpus figure and its reporting date against the most recent MoEFCC/CAG report before citing a specific number in an answer.
- ANALYSIS: **Interpretation caution:** CAMPA fund utilisation rates (how much of the accrued corpus has actually been spent on the ground versus remaining unspent) have been a recurring audit/parliamentary-committee concern - cite the specific report and date when referencing utilisation performance.

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: distinguish CAMPA's diversion-triggered, compensatory funding logic from the Green India Mission's broader climate-policy mandate.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: CAMPA fund utilisation and quality-of-restoration critiques are used to argue for stronger monitoring of afforestation outcomes rather than a focus on quantity planted alone.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Argue that compensatory afforestation should be judged by ecological restoration quality (native-species fidelity, survival rate, ecosystem-service recovery), not just hectares planted or funds disbursed.
- ANALYSIS: Use the Green India Mission's ecosystem-service framing to argue for integrating afforestation policy with climate-mitigation (carbon sequestration) and livelihood (agroforestry, non-timber forest produce) objectives simultaneously.
- ANALYSIS: Conclude with an outcome-monitoring thesis: fund availability (CAMPA corpus) is not itself evidence of successful forest restoration without independent ecological outcome verification.

Answer thesis: Distinguish CAMPA's diversion-triggered compensatory-financing role from the Green India Mission's broader climate-and-ecosystem restoration mandate, and judge both by ecological restoration quality and independently verified outcomes, not by fund corpus size or area-planted figures alone.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Distinguish the triggering mechanism and funding source of CAMPA from the Green India Mission's mandate under NAPCC.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Explain how the Compensatory Afforestation Fund is generated and utilised under the CAMPA framework.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "Quantity of afforestation funding does not guarantee quality of ecological restoration." Discuss with reference to CAMPA and the Green India Mission.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
advanced/12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md.
- FACT: 03_Ecological-Succession-and-Biomes.md - the successional-restoration-quality standard this topic's afforestation should be judged against.
- FACT: 11_Forest-Types-and-Forest-Rights-Act.md - community-rights interaction with afforestation implementation.
- FACT: 20_India-Climate-Policy-NAPCC-Panchamrit-LTLEDS.md - the Green India Mission's full NAPCC policy context.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	40	Plan Vivo certified REDD+ projects and community forest carbon conservation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Plan Vivo certified REDD+ projects and community forest carbon conservation

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

13. Core answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Demand decoder and thesis

- Start with the trigger: **forest diversion -> user-agency payment -> CAF/CAMPA**. Contrast it with **GIM's broader ecosystem-service mission** before evaluating either.
- **Thesis:** CAMPA can finance mitigation of diversion, but neither a fund balance, a plantation nor a green credit is evidence that a mature ecosystem has been replaced.

13.2 Reusable evidence units

Claim	Named evidence/example -> significance	Qualification
The instrument is legally triggered, not a general greening programme.	Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam/forest-diversion approval + NPV and compensatory-afforestation payments -> explains CAMPA's source of funds.	The 2023 statutory scope and the February 2024 interim <i>Godavarma</i> direction must be read together; do not state either as the whole law.
Offset accounting has an ecological limit.	Mature forest diversion versus new compensatory plantation -> succession, soil, species composition and location make like-for-like replacement difficult.	This critiques equivalence, not the need for restoration finance.
Metrics measure different things.	CAF accrual, green-credit action and ISFR canopy -> money, registered action and detected cover are separate outputs.	None independently proves ecological restoration achieved.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

- **10 marks:** show payment/fund flow, then contrast CAMPA and GIM.
- **15/20 marks:** add native-biome/site-selection, FRA/Gram Sabha due diligence, independent survival/function monitoring and fund-utilisation timing.
- **NAPCC discipline:** say **eight original missions; nine as currently described by Government with the health mission**. Do not claim that a historical eight-mission list has been legally replaced by a new NAPCC statute.

13.4 2026 community-carbon micro-card

Khasi Hills Community REDD+ Project, East Khasi Hills, Meghalaya is India's first **Plan Vivo-certified REDD+** project (Plan Vivo project record; certification 2013). Use it to illustrate community-led forest-carbon conservation, traditional local governance and benefit-sharing. Do not infer a current carbon-credit volume, community-income share or ecological outcome without the relevant verified project monitoring period.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	68	Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management Planning Authority	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	24	New York Declaration on Forests and deforestation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	97	Hyderabad recognition as Tree City of the World	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management Planning Authority
- New York Declaration on Forests and deforestation
- Hyderabad recognition as Tree City of the World

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - AUDITED PYQS AND LIVE-DATA BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Audited PYQs and live-data boundary

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Audited PYQs · live-data boundary · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: CAMPA, established under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016, is the statutory authority managing planning, fund release and monitoring of how these funds are utilised by states for compensatory afforestation, forest regeneration, wildlife management, and forest infrastructure.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not infer PYQ keys or current fund figures from stubs.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Godavarman Thirumulpad (1996) continue to govern - preserving protection for forest-like land that is not formally recorded as forest.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Audited PYQ ownership - Live-data boundary Qualified use: Close with answer-free PYQs and failed current fund-data attempts.

ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Forest governance connects diversion approval, compensatory levies, CAMPA fund architecture, ecological restoration and Green India Mission objectives across Union, state and local institutions.
- **Close distinction:** Compensatory afforestation is not ecological equivalence, fund collection is not expenditure or restoration, plantation area is not survival or native ecosystem recovery, and mission target is not achievement.
- **Mechanism / status / evidence limit:** Date the governing Act/rules/guidelines and scheme status; trace diversion, valuation, fund transfer, site choice, species mix, monitoring and outcome with community-rights safeguards.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Diversion approval first?

A. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. B. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. C. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. D. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Diversion approval first?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. C. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. D. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Answer: B. Explanation: Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Diversion approval first without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Diversion approval first?

A. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. D. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.

Answer: D. Explanation: Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies CAMPA trigger?

A. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: A. Explanation: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CAMPA trigger?

A. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. B. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. C. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. D. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

Answer: B. Explanation: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses CAMPA trigger without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CAMPA trigger?

A. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

Answer: D. Explanation: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies NPV distinction?

A. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: A. Explanation: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NPV distinction?

A. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. B. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. C. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: B. Explanation: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses NPV distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. B. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. C. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. D. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Answer: C. Explanation: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NPV distinction?

A. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. B. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. C. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. D. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Answer: D. Explanation: Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies CAF Act architecture?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CAF Act architecture?

A. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. D. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses CAF Act architecture without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. D. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CAF Act architecture?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. C. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. D. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies National authority boundary?

A. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. B. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of National authority boundary?

A. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. B. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses National authority boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. D. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about National authority boundary?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies State authority boundary?

A. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Answer: A. Explanation: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of State authority boundary?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

Answer: B. Explanation: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses State authority boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. D. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

Answer: C. Explanation: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State authority boundary?

A. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. B. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. C. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. D. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.

Answer: D. Explanation: State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Fund-flow discipline?

A. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. B. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

Answer: A. Explanation: An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Fund-flow discipline?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. C. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. D. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Fund-flow discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. B. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. C. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. D. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Fund-flow discipline?

A. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. B. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. C. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. D. An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Answer: D. Explanation: An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Permitted-use boundary?

A. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. B. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. C. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. D. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

Answer: A. Explanation: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Permitted-use boundary?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. C. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. D. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Answer: B. Explanation: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Permitted-use boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. D. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Answer: C. Explanation: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Permitted-use boundary?

A. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.

Answer: D. Explanation: CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Compensation limit?

A. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. B. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. C. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. D. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

Answer: A. Explanation: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Compensation limit?

A. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. B. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. C. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. D. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Answer: B. Explanation: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Compensation limit without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. D. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

Answer: C. Explanation: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Compensation limit?

A. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. B. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. C. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. D. A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.

Answer: D. Explanation: A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Site and tenure due diligence?

A. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. D. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Answer: A. Explanation: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Site and tenure due diligence?

A. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. B. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Answer: B. Explanation: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Site and tenure due diligence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. B. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. C. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. D. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Answer: C. Explanation: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Site and tenure due diligence?

A. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. B. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. C. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. D. Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.

Answer: D. Explanation: Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Output versus outcome?

A. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. B. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Answer: A. Explanation: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Output versus outcome?

A. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. B. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Answer: B. Explanation: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Output versus outcome without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. C. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. D. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Output versus outcome?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. D. Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies GIM policy identity?

A. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. D. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of GIM policy identity?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses GIM policy identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. B. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. C. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. D. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GIM policy identity?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. D. The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies GIM official targets?

A. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. B. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. C. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. D. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

Answer: A. Explanation: The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of GIM official targets?

A. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. B. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. C. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. D. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses GIM official targets without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. C. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. D. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.

Answer: C. Explanation: The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GIM official targets?

A. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. D. The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Answer: D. Explanation: The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies GIM ecosystem scope?

A. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. D. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Answer: A. Explanation: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of GIM ecosystem scope?

A. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. B. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. C. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. D. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Answer: B. Explanation: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses GIM ecosystem scope without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. D. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.

Answer: C. Explanation: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GIM ecosystem scope?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. C. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. D. The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.

Answer: D. Explanation: The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies GIM convergence?

A. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. D. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Answer: A. Explanation: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of GIM convergence?

A. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. B. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. C. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses GIM convergence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. C. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GIM convergence?

A. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. D. MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Answer: D. Explanation: MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Mission-versus-CAMPA?

A. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. D. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

Answer: A. Explanation: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Mission-versus-CAMPA?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. C. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Mission-versus-CAMPA without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. D. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.

Answer: C. Explanation: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Mission-versus-CAMPA?

A. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. B. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. C. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. D. CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Answer: D. Explanation: CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Forest-law vintage?

A. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. B. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. C. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Forest-law vintage?

A. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. B. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Forest-law vintage without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. C. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Forest-law vintage?

A. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. B. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. C. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. D. The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records;

both must be stated together.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Green-credit boundary?

A. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. D. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

Answer: A. Explanation: A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Green-credit boundary?

A. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. B. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

Answer: B. Explanation: A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Green-credit boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. B. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. C. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. D. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Answer: C. Explanation: A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Green-credit boundary?

A. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. D. A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

Answer: D. Explanation: A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership?

A. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. B. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

Answer: A. Explanation: Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership?”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ ownership?”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?

A. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. C. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. D. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.

Answer: B. Explanation: Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?” as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?
Analysis: Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or

legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** C. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For “Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ ownership?”, explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. C. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. D. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Answer: C. Explanation: Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or...”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or status?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Q75. Which statement uses Audited PYQ ownership without changing its scale, parameter or...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. C. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Live-data boundary?

A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. B. Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. C. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. D. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.

Answer: A. Explanation: Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Live-data boundary?

A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. B. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. C. When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. D. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Answer: B. Explanation: Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Live-data boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. D. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Live-data boundary?

A. State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. B. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. C. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. D. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

Answer: D. Explanation: Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership?” as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Live-data boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For “Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ ownership?”, explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

AUDITED CAMPA, FOREST-POLICY AND COMMUNITY-CARBON PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route four objective demands: CAMPA in 2019, the New York Declaration on Forests and Tree City in 2021, and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community forest carbon. No direct Mains demand or objective answer key is invented; the concepts are carried into practice.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: distinguish CAMPA's diversion-triggered, compensatory funding logic from the Green India Mission's broader climate-policy mandate.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: CAMPA fund utilisation and quality-of-restoration critiques are used to argue for stronger monitoring of afforestation outcomes rather than a focus on quantity planted alone.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	40	Plan Vivo certified REDD+ projects and community forest carbon conservation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Plan Vivo certified REDD+ projects and community forest carbon conservation

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021

- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	68	Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management Planning Authority	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	24	New York Declaration on Forests and deforestation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	97	Hyderabad recognition as Tree City of the World	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management Planning Authority
- New York Declaration on Forests and deforestation
- Hyderabad recognition as Tree City of the World

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on CAMPA typically test the National/State CAF share-split logic and the NPV/compensatory-afforestation-cost payment trigger - apply these mechanics directly.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "forest restoration policy" should explicitly engage the ecological-commensurability critique (Section 1) and the fund-utilisation-gap critique (Section 2) together, rather than describing CAMPA/GIM only descriptively.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the sequence from forest-diversion approval to compensatory payments. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAMPA trigger. **Named evidence/example:** When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NPV distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.
- When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.
- Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAMPA trigger.

Named evidence/example: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NPV distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the sequence from forest-diversion approval to compensatory payments. Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAMPA trigger.

Named evidence/example: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NPV distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty,

causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAMPA trigger.

Named evidence/example: When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NPV distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the sequence from forest-diversion approval to compensatory payments. Answer in about...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Fund authorities. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.
- The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.
- State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.
- An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the

applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Fund authorities. Answer in...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or

performance stage. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State authority boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Fund authorities. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain why CAMPA performance must be tracked from accrual through ecological outcome. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permitted-use boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or

infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.
- CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.
- Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.
- Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permitted-use boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why CAMPA performance must be tracked from accrual through ecological outcome. Answer...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permitted-use boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permitted-use boundary. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why CAMPA performance must be tracked from accrual through ecological outcome. Answer...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Green India Mission from CAMPA and classify the official GIM targets correctly. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM ecosystem scope. **Named evidence/example:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted

parcel. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM convergence. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Mission-versus-CAMPA. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.
- The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.
- The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.
- MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.
- CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM ecosystem scope. **Named evidence/example:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM convergence. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Mission-versus-CAMPA. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service

objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish Green India Mission from CAMPA and classify the official GIM targets correctly....”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM ecosystem scope. **Named evidence/example:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM convergence. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Mission-versus-CAMPA. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader

than compensating one diverted parcel. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.

Analysis: Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence.

Qualification: State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM ecosystem scope. **Named evidence/example:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM convergence. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Mission-versus-CAMPA. **Named evidence/example:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard

and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish Green India Mission from CAMPA and classify the official GIM targets correctly....”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the ecological equivalence and tenure assumptions in compensatory afforestation.

Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Compensation limit. **Named evidence/example:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Site and tenure due diligence. **Named evidence/example:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green-credit boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green-credit boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.
- Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.
- Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.
- A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Compensation limit. **Named evidence/example:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Site and tenure due diligence. **Named evidence/example:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded

does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green-credit boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Critically examine the ecological equivalence and tenure assumptions in compensatory...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Compensation limit. **Named evidence/example:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Site and tenure due diligence. **Named evidence/example:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green-credit boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not

make it rights-free or ecologically empty. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Compensation limit. **Named evidence/example:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Site and tenure due diligence. **Named evidence/example:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Output versus outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green-credit boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically examine the ecological equivalence and tenure assumptions in compensatory...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named

law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Build a current forest-governance answer integrating law, CAMPA, GIM and evidence limits. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-law vintage. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ ownership. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.
- The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.
- An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.
- The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.
- The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.
- The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.
- Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.
- Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-law vintage. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ

ownership. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Build a current forest-governance answer integrating law, CAMPA, GIM and evidence limits...”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAF Act architecture.

Named evidence/example: The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Forest-law vintage. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ ownership. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

8. **Claim and named evidence:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Diversion approval first. **Named evidence/example:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CAF Act architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Fund-flow discipline. **Named evidence/example:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM policy identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** GIM official targets. **Named evidence/example:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-law vintage. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ ownership. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Live-data boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence

boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Build a current forest-governance answer integrating law, CAMPA, GIM and evidence limits....”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims. **Core area:** Compensatory afforestation and national forest-restoration policy. **Grounded in:** Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 and Rules, 2018 (India Code); CAG/parliamentary committee reports on CAF utilisation; Green India Mission operational guidelines; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. **Companion:** basic/12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md.

1. The "compensation" premise and its ecological critique

ANALYSIS: The single most important advanced-level critique of CAMPA is conceptual: it assumes a biodiversity-rich, mature natural forest (often diverted for mining/infrastructure) can be "compensated" by planting an equivalent area of new afforestation elsewhere - but ecological succession theory (Topic 03) shows that a newly planted stand cannot replicate a mature forest's structure, species composition or accumulated ecosystem services within any policy-relevant timeframe. This is why "no net loss" framing in official communication is frequently challenged by ecologists as ecologically incommensurable rather than a genuine like-for-like offset - a sophisticated point for Mains answers evaluating CAMPA's design.

2. Fund architecture and the fund-utilisation gap

Layer	Statutory function	Documented performance concern
FACT: National CAF	Retains a smaller specified share of accrued funds for national priorities (e.g., cross-state or strategic afforestation/wildlife activities).	Utilisation and planning at the national level have faced periodic parliamentary-committee/CAG scrutiny regarding pace of disbursal.
FACT: State CAFs	Receive the larger share for state-level compensatory afforestation, forest regeneration, wildlife management, and permitted forest infrastructure.	A recurring audit finding across several years has been that a substantial share of accrued state CAF corpus remained unspent or under-utilised relative to available funds, alongside quality concerns about how spent funds were utilised.

ANALYSIS: Analytical point: the fund-utilisation gap (large accrued corpus with comparatively slow/uneven spending) has been a repeated theme in CAG and parliamentary standing committee reviews of CAMPA - this is distinct from, but compounds, the deeper ecological- commensurability critique in Section 1: even if compensation were ecologically adequate in principle, slow fund utilisation further delays any restoration benefit.

3. Green India Mission: scope, targets and implementation reality

1. **FACT:** The Green India Mission (GIM), one of NAPCC's eight missions, is explicitly designed around ecosystem-service enhancement - carbon sequestration, biodiversity, water regulation, and livelihood support through agroforestry and non-timber forest produce - rather than a narrow area-of-tree-cover target alone.

2. ANALYSIS: **Implementation reality:** GIM's cross-cutting mandate (spanning forest quality, agroforestry, wetlands, grasslands and urban green spaces) has meant its funding and institutional ownership are more diffused across multiple schemes and departments compared to CAMPA's single, dedicated statutory fund - making GIM's aggregate progress harder to track through one unified national metric than CAMPA's more narrowly defined spend/output figures.

3. ANALYSIS: **Analytical synthesis:** GIM and CAMPA can, in principle, be mutually reinforcing - CAMPA-funded compensatory afforestation could be designed to meet GIM's ecosystem- service and native-species-quality standards rather than being reported as a separate, purely quantity-based accounting exercise - but this integration is not automatic and depends on deliberate convergence in state-level implementation planning.

3A. The 2023 amendment and the 2024 judicial correction: a two-step legal shift

ANALYSIS: Advanced answers on forest governance now have to handle a **statute-versus-judgment interaction**, not just a single law:

Step	What changed	Analytical reading
FACT: Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act, 2023 renamed the 1980 Act to the Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980 and defined its applicability by reference to land <i>notified</i> as forest under the Indian Forest Act, 1927 or <i>recorded</i> as forest in government records on or after 25 October 1980.	The reform's stated purpose was regulatory certainty: user agencies and states had faced ambiguity about which land needed prior central approval.	ANALYSIS: The cost of certainty is coverage: land that is ecologically forest but never entered the record risks falling outside the Act's prior-approval requirement.
FACT: The 2023 Act exempted specified categories from prior approval - including land within 100 km of international borders/LoC/LAC for strategic linear projects of national importance and security, limited areas for security infrastructure, defence projects, and land alongside rail lines and public roads for access.	Security and connectivity imperatives in border and remote regions.	ANALYSIS: Note <i>where</i> the exemptions bite: the 100 km border belt includes the biodiversity-rich Himalaya and the North-East - so the exemption is not spatially neutral with respect to biodiversity.
FACT: Supreme Court, February 2024 (<i>Ashok Kumar Sharma v. Union of India</i> proceedings): directed that the broad "dictionary meaning" of forest from T.N. Godavarman Thirumulpad (1996) continue to apply pending the compilation and submission of State expert-committee records of forest-like land.	Judicial preservation of the ecological test during the transition.	ANALYSIS: This is the single most examinable sentence in current Indian forest law: the statutory definition narrowed, and the Court held the ecological definition in place in the interim.

ANALYSIS: **Answer-writing discipline:** describe this as *statute narrowed -> Court preserved interim breadth -> State records pending*, and never assert that the *Godavarman* definition has been either abolished (it has not) or permanently entrenched (the interim direction is tied to the record-compilation process).

4. Compensatory afforestation site-quality issues in depth

- ANALYSIS: Independent field studies and civil-society assessments have repeatedly flagged concerns including: afforestation carried out with fast-growing, sometimes non-native or monoculture species (undermining native-biome fidelity, Topic 03); survival-rate data that is not consistently, independently verified years after planting; and instances where land nominally used for "degraded forest land" compensatory afforestation already carried community use rights or ongoing FRA claims (Topic 11), creating land-use conflict.

- ANALYSIS: **Balanced framing:** these are documented implementation critiques from a range of sources (including government audit bodies themselves), not evidence that the CAMPA mechanism is entirely without merit - the statutory fund-collection and planning architecture is sound in principle; the gap lies in ecological-quality standards, monitoring rigour and land-tenure due diligence at implementation.

5. Data and conceptual limitations

- ANALYSIS: Precise, currently accurate figures for total CAMPA fund accrual, state-wise disbursal and utilisation rate change year to year and are reported through CAG audit reports and parliamentary standing committee reports with different reference dates - cite the specific report and its date rather than a static corpus figure.
- ANALYSIS: There is no single, comprehensive, independently verified national dataset tracking the long-term (multi-decade) survival and ecological maturation of CAMPA-funded plantations; most publicly available assessments are site-specific studies rather than a nationwide monitoring system - a genuine, frequently cited data gap.
- ANALYSIS: Green India Mission's aggregate physical/financial progress reporting is distributed across implementing state agencies and multiple central schemes, making a single, precise national "GIM achievement" figure difficult to state with confidence without citing a specific MoEFCC progress report and its date.

6. Recurring UPSC analytical tensions

Tension	Balanced framing
Development need for forest-land diversion vs ecological irreplaceability of mature forest	CAMPA's compensation framework provides a funding mechanism but cannot fully offset the ecological loss of mature forest in any short-to-medium policy timeframe.
Large accrued CAMPA corpus vs slow/uneven fund utilisation	Statutory fund-collection design is effective; the implementation bottleneck is disbursal pace, planning capacity and monitoring rigour at the state level.
CAMPA's area/spend-based reporting vs GIM's ecosystem-service-quality standard	Genuine integration (CAMPA funds meeting GIM ecological-quality standards) is possible but requires deliberate state-level convergence, not automatic alignment.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: CAG and parliamentary standing committee reviews have repeatedly flagged CAMPA fund under-utilisation (slow disbursal/spending relative to the accrued corpus) as a persistent implementation concern.
- FACT: The Green India Mission's mandate spans forest quality, agroforestry, wetlands, grasslands and urban green spaces - broader than a single "tree-planting area" target.
- FACT: Independent assessments have flagged concerns about non-native/monoculture species use and inconsistent survival-rate verification in some compensatory-afforestation sites.
- FACT: CAMPA and GIM are governed by different institutional architectures (a single dedicated statutory fund for CAMPA versus a multi-scheme, multi-department structure for GIM).

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: CAMPA fund utilisation has been consistently rapid and fully matches accrued corpus every year. -> Audit and parliamentary reviews have repeatedly flagged utilisation lags and unspent-corpus concerns.
- WRONG: Compensatory afforestation is considered an ecologically equivalent, "no net loss" substitute for diverted mature forest by ecological consensus. -> This equivalence is widely challenged on ecological-succession grounds; new plantations cannot replicate mature-forest structure/services within any short-to-medium timeframe.
- WRONG: The Green India Mission has a single, unified national tracking metric analogous to CAMPA's fund-accrual figure. -> GIM's progress reporting is more diffused across multiple schemes/departments, making a single aggregate metric harder to state precisely.
- WRONG: Compensatory-afforestation land is always genuinely unencumbered, rights-free land. -> Some documented cases show overlap with existing community-use or FRA-claim areas, creating land-use conflict.

9. CURRENT: Current anchor - analytical use

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: CAG/parliamentary standing committee reviews of CAMPA fund utilisation (verify the latest report and its specific figures/date before citing).	Use to evidence the fund-utilisation-gap critique analytically, rather than citing a specific corpus figure without its report date.
CURRENT: Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act, 2023 (renaming and scope redefinition) read with the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserving the <i>Godavarma</i> definition pending State expert-committee records.	The current legal baseline for any question on forest diversion, CAMPA triggers or "what counts as forest". Always present the two together - quoting only the amendment overstates the narrowing; quoting only the judgment understates the statutory change.
CURRENT: Economic Survey 2025-26 (Ch. 10): ecosystem-based approaches and restoration are being incentivised through the Afforestation and Green Credit Programme , encouraging public and private participation in compensatory afforestation and degraded-forest restoration.	The newest layer on the CAMPA stack - and the sharpest current version of the quantity-versus-quality critique, because a credit earned per unit of plantation is, by construction, an <i>input</i> metric.

ANALYSIS: **Announced vs achieved**: CAMPA corpus figures measure **money accrued**, green credits measure **actions registered**, and ISFR measures **canopy detected**. None of the three measures **ecological restoration achieved** - say so explicitly in a Mains answer; it is the single highest-value analytical sentence in this topic.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on CAMPA typically test the National/State CAF share-split logic and the NPV/compensatory-afforestation-cost payment trigger - apply these mechanics directly.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "forest restoration policy" should explicitly engage the ecological-commensurability critique (Section 1) and the fund-utilisation-gap critique (Section 2) together, rather than describing CAMPA/GIM only descriptively.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: CAMPA's statutory fund-collection architecture is sound, but its underlying "compensation" premise faces a genuine ecological-commensurability critique (new plantations cannot replicate diverted mature forest within policy-relevant timeframes), compounded by a documented fund-utilisation gap; genuine progress requires CAMPA-funded afforestation to be held to the Green India Mission's ecosystem-service-quality and native-species standards, with independent, long-term ecological monitoring.

1. State CAMPA's diversion-triggered, NPV-based funding mechanism and the National/State CAF structure.
2. Introduce the ecological-commensurability critique of the "compensation" premise, linking to succession theory (Topic 03).
3. Cite the documented fund-utilisation gap from CAG/parliamentary review as a distinct, compounding implementation problem.
4. Explain the Green India Mission's broader ecosystem-service mandate and its more diffused institutional/reporting architecture compared to CAMPA.
5. Conclude with a recommendation to integrate CAMPA spending with GIM's ecological-quality standards and independent, long-term outcome monitoring.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: Identify the correct National/State CAF fund-share structure and the NPV payment trigger under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks)**: Why is "no net loss" compensatory afforestation ecologically contested as a substitute for diverted mature forest?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks)**: Critically evaluate CAMPA's fund-utilisation record and propose reforms to align compensatory afforestation with Green India Mission ecological-quality standards.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: basic/12_Forest-Governance-CAMPA-and-Green-India-Mission.md.
- FACT: 03_Ecological-Succession-and-Biomes.md - the ecological-commensurability critique's theoretical basis.
- FACT: 11_Forest-Types-and-Forest-Rights-Act.md - the land-tenure conflict risk in compensatory-afforestation site selection.
- FACT: 20_India-Climate-Policy-NAPCC-Panchamrit-LTLEDS.md - Green India Mission's place within India's full climate-policy architecture.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission: DIVERSION, NPV, CA COST, FUND AND AUTHORITY MAP

1. **Diversion approval first:** Prior Central approval for specified non-forest use of covered forest land belongs to the forest-conservation statute; approval, rejection or exemption is a legal decision distinct from later compensatory-afforestation finance.
2. **CAMPA trigger:** When an approved diversion carries compensatory conditions, the user agency pays the applicable compensatory-afforestation cost and Net Present Value; a fund flow does not itself grant diversion approval.
3. **NPV distinction:** Net Present Value monetises specified foregone forest ecosystem services for the approval framework, while compensatory-afforestation cost finances plantation or restoration activity; the two payments are related but not identical.
4. **CAF Act architecture:** The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 establishes National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and their authorities for receiving and using eligible monies under the statutory framework.
5. **National authority boundary:** The National Authority and National Fund perform central planning, coordination, monitoring and nationally assigned functions; they do not replace State Authorities as the ordinary executors of state plans.
6. **State authority boundary:** State Authorities prepare and implement the applicable annual plans and use State Fund resources for permitted activities; a release or approved plan is not proof of completed ecological restoration.
7. **Fund-flow discipline:** An answer must trace user agency payment to the applicable fund, authority, approved plan, release, expenditure, physical output and ecological outcome; each is a separate accounting or performance stage.
8. **Permitted-use boundary:** CAMPA monies may support compensatory afforestation and other permitted forest, wildlife, regeneration, protection or infrastructure activities under the Act and Rules; no allocation or expenditure value is assumed without the dated record.
9. **Compensation limit:** A plantation cannot reproduce the structure, species composition, soil history, spatial location and accumulated services of a mature natural forest within the project accounting period; finance mitigates loss but does not prove ecological equivalence.
10. **Site and tenure due diligence:** Compensatory-afforestation land must be checked for ecological suitability, native-biome fidelity, existing use and recognised or pending forest rights; describing land as degraded does not make it rights-free or ecologically empty.
11. **Output versus outcome:** Money accrued, money spent, seedlings planted, area treated, canopy detected and ecosystem function restored are different metrics; none can be substituted for the next without monitoring evidence.
12. **GIM policy identity:** The Green India Mission is one of the original eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change and combines adaptation and mitigation through forest and ecosystem restoration; it is not the CAMPA statute.

13. **GIM official targets:** The retrieved MoEFCC page publishes mission targets of increasing forest or tree cover over 5 million hectares, improving quality over another 5 million hectares and enhancing forest-based livelihood income for about 3 million families; these are targets, not verified achievements.
14. **GIM ecosystem scope:** The official page emphasises biodiversity, water, biomass, mangroves, wetlands, critical habitats, carbon storage, agroforestry, social forestry and urban or peri-urban tree cover; GIM is broader than compensating one diverted parcel.
15. **GIM convergence:** MoEFCC describes convergence with CAMPA and MGNREGS and a role for local communities; convergence is a planning approach, not automatic pooling of every fund or proof of implementation.
16. **Mission-versus-CAMPA:** CAMPA is diversion-triggered statutory compensation finance, whereas GIM is a broader mission with ecosystem-service objectives and multiple implementation channels; overlap in activity does not make them one programme.
17. **Forest-law vintage:** The Forest Conservation Amendment Act, 2023 renamed and altered the scope of the 1980 statute, while the Supreme Court's February 2024 interim direction preserved the broader Godavarman forest meaning pending State records; both must be stated together.
18. **Green-credit boundary:** A green credit for an eligible environmental action is not a carbon credit and is not proof that a diverted mature ecosystem has been replaced; action registration, carbon accounting and ecological outcome are separate.
19. **Audited PYQ ownership:** Audited ledgers route 2019 CAMPA, 2021 New York Declaration on Forests, 2021 Tree City and provisional 2026 Plan Vivo community-carbon demands to Topic 12; no objective key is inferred.
20. **Live-data boundary:** Official CAMPA pages attempted on 2026-09-03 yielded HTTP 404 or DNS failure and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, afforestation-area, survival or outcome figure is asserted.

Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission: CAMPA, GIM, TARGET, TENURE, METRIC AND EQUIVALENCE TRAPS

- Do not treat CAMPA payment as the legal approval for diversion.
- Do not merge NPV and compensatory-afforestation cost.
- Do not assign State implementation to the National Authority.
- Do not assign national coordination to a State Authority.
- Do not treat an approved annual plan as completed work.
- Do not report accrued funds as expenditure.
- Do not report expenditure as plantation survival or ecosystem restoration.
- Do not treat compensatory plantation as like-for-like mature forest.
- Do not assume degraded land is rights-free.
- Do not merge CAMPA and Green India Mission.
- Do not report GIM targets as achieved outputs or outcomes.
- Do not infer fund convergence from policy convergence.
- Do not state the 2023 amendment without the 2024 interim judicial direction.
- Do not equate green credit with carbon credit.
- Do not infer PYQ keys or current fund figures from stubs.

Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission: FOREST-GOVERNANCE ANSWER SPINE

START WITH THE FOREST-DIVERSION APPROVAL OR EXEMPTION QUESTION
-> SEPARATE NPV FROM COMPENSATORY-AFFORESTATION COST
-> TRACE NATIONAL AND STATE FUND-AUTHORITY ROLES
-> MOVE FROM ACCRUAL TO PLAN TO RELEASE TO SPEND TO OUTPUT TO OUTCOME
-> DISTINGUISH CAMPA'S TRIGGER FROM GIM'S MISSION OBJECTIVES
-> LABEL EVERY GIM NUMBER AS TARGET OR DATED ACHIEVEMENT
-> CONCLUDE WITH NATIVE-BIOME, FRA AND LONG-TERM MONITORING SAFEGUARDS

Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission: LIVE FUND, EXPENDITURE, AREA, OUTCOME AND PYQ EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

The official MoEFCC GIM page was substantively retrieved for mission identity, ecosystem scope, convergence and published targets. Those targets are not reported as achievements. CAMPA paths failed with HTTP 404 or DNS error and the FSI page was a contact-only stub, so no fund, allocation, expenditure, area, survival or outcome figure was used.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Diversion-to-finance firewall

PROJECT PROPOSAL -> forest-conservation legal scrutiny
PRIOR CENTRAL APPROVAL OR EXEMPTION TEST -> legal decision
CONDITIONS -> compensatory afforestation and NPV where applicable
USER AGENCY PAYMENT -> finance trigger
RULE -> payment never substitutes for approval
MUST REMEMBER: Forest governance connects diversion approval, compensatory levies, CAMPA...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Payment distinction

NPV -> specified ecosystem-service value in the approval framework
CA COST -> finances compensatory plantation or restoration activity
BOTH -> may arise from an approved diversion condition
NEITHER -> evidence that ecological replacement has occurred
VERIFY -> rate, category and date from the applicable order

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Fund architecture

CAF ACT 2016 -> statutory framework
NATIONAL FUND -> centrally assigned receipts and uses
NATIONAL AUTHORITY -> central planning, coordination and monitoring
STATE FUND -> state-assigned receipts and uses
STATE AUTHORITY -> annual plan and on-ground implementation

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: National-State authority matrix

NATIONAL -> coordination, national functions and oversight
STATE -> plan preparation, execution and reporting
TRANSFER OR RELEASE -> financial stage
EXPENDITURE -> accounting stage
OUTCOME -> ecological evidence stage

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Performance chain

ACCRUAL -> money received
PLAN -> approved proposed activity
RELEASE -> money made available
EXPENDITURE -> money booked as spent
OUTPUT AND OUTCOME -> physical work then ecological effect

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Permitted-use gate

PROPOSED ACTIVITY -> locate Act, Rules and annual plan authority
PERMITTED USE -> afforestation or other eligible forest activity
AUTHORITY -> National or State role
RECORD -> dated sanction and expenditure evidence
NO FIGURE -> never infer allocation, spend or area

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Ecological equivalence test

DIVERTED MATURE FOREST -> layered structure and accumulated history
NEW PLANTATION -> young stand with different location and trajectory
AREA MATCH -> administrative comparison only
CANOPY GAIN -> does not prove biodiversity or hydrological recovery
VERDICT -> compensation finance is not like-for-like replacement

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Site and rights gate

LAND IDENTIFIED -> verify legal and recorded status
ECOLOGY -> match native biome, soil, water and connectivity
TENURE -> check recognised and pending FRA rights
COMMUNITY -> include rights holders in planning and monitoring
NO EMPTY-LAND ASSUMPTION -> degraded does not mean unused

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: GIM identity and scope

NAPCC -> original eight-mission architecture
GIM -> adaptation plus mitigation mission
ECOSYSTEMS -> forests, wetlands, mangroves and critical habitats
LANDSCAPES -> agroforestry, social forestry and urban tree cover
LIVELIHOODS -> forest-dependent households and local communities

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Target-versus-achievement gate

OFFICIAL TARGET -> 5 mha cover increase
OFFICIAL TARGET -> quality improvement over another 5 mha
OFFICIAL TARGET -> livelihood income for about 3 million families
ACHIEVEMENT CLAIM -> requires dated monitoring evidence
RULE -> mission target is not actual output or outcome
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Compensatory afforestation is not ecological equivalence, fund...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Convergence matrix

GIM -> ecosystem-service mission objectives
CAMPAs -> diversion-triggered statutory finance
MGNREGS -> eligible labour and asset channel
CONVERGENCE -> align plans, sites and monitoring
NO AUTOMATICITY -> institutions and accounts remain distinct
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Date the governing Act/rules/guidelines...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Law metric and PYQ spine

LAW -> 2023 statute plus February 2024 interim direction
FINANCE -> approval, NPV, CA cost and fund flow
MISSION -> GIM targets separated from achievements
METRIC -> accrual, spend, output and outcome kept distinct
AUDIT -> objective PYQs and failed live figures remain answer-free